



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

NOVEMBER

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Good Things Happen
is the newsletter of
Minnehaha United Methodist Church,
published each month.

**The deadline for December is
November 16**

Contributions may be brought to the
office or emailed to:
office@minnehaha.org
**3701 East 50th Street
Minneapolis, MN 55417**

About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011

November



SUNDAY WORSHIP

9:00 am Worship with organ and choir.

10:00 am Education and Fellowship

11:00 am Worship with band and vocals.

Infant and toddler care available all morning.

Minnehaha Happenings in November

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
		1 All Saints Day 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 12p Music Lesson 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters	2 10a Staff Meeting 1p Minnehaha circle 4p Methodicals 6:45p Chancel Choir 7p Children's Council	3 9a Food Shelf Board 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Play-date 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a We Make the Road by Walking	4 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA	5 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
6 Daylight Saving Time Ends Communion 9a Worship with Organ & Choir 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship with Band 6p Youth & Confirmation Classes 6:30p Togo 7p SAA	7 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy/Cub Scouts 6:30p Finance 6:30p On this Spirit Walk	8 Election Day 7a Election- Polls Open 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 12p Music Lesson 1:30p Brighter Minds Music	9 Bazaar set-up 9:30a Nokomis Circle 4p Methodicals 6:45p Chancel Choir 7:30p SPR	10 9a Food Shelf Board 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Play-date 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a We Make the Road by Walking 1p Communion @ Nokomis Sq	11 Veterans' Day 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA 7p Fellowship Hall reserved 7p Taizé	12 Holiday Bazaar 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
13 9a Worship with Organ & Choir 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship with Band 6p Youth Night (grades 6-12) 7p SAA	14 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts 6:30p On this Spirit Walk	15 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 12p Music Lesson 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6p Nokomis Prov. 6:30p Church Council 6:30p Toastmasters	16 Newsletter items due 4p Methodicals 6:45p Chancel Choir	17 Great American Smokeout 9a Food Shelf Board 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Play-date 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a We Make the Road by Walking 6p Mandala Parent Night 6:30p Trustees & B+G	18 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA	19 7a MinneHarvest 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
20 9a Worship with Organ & Choir 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship with Band 1p Leadership Training 6p Youth & Confirmation Classes 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	21 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy/Cub Scouts 6:30p On this Spirit Walk 6:30p Women's Soul Group	22 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 12p Music Lesson 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 7p SPR	23 9a Newsletter Collation 4p Methodicals 6:45p Chancel Choir 7p Thanksgiving Eve @ Lake Nokomis Lutheran	24 Thanksgiving Day 9a Food Shelf Board 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Play-date 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a We Make the Road by Walking	25 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA	26 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
27 Advent begins 9a Worship with Organ & Choir 10a Advent Wreath Making 11a Worship with Band 6p Youth & Confirmation Classes 7p SAA	28 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts 6:30p On this Spirit Walk	29 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 12p Music Lesson 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Worship Committee	30 4p Methodicals 6:45p Chancel Choir	Notes: To avoid conflicts, please contact the office <i>before</i> scheduling ANY event or meeting. Thank you!		

Worship in November

Now that we've explored a variety of spiritual types, we turn our imaginations to what could be. In November, we'll explore the imagination, both ours and God's. An ecumenical (multi-denominational) Thanksgiving Eve service will be held at Lake Nokomis Lutheran with pie served afterwards, and then our four Sundays of Advent start with Nov. 27. We'll be seeing the word – each of the scripture passages for Advent paints an evocative scene which we will continue to fill in in worship with sound, word, and pictures. Join us!

6th	“A Lack of Imagination” <i>All Saints Sunday, Communion</i>	Luke 20:27-38
13th	“Imagine a New Thing”	Isaiah 65:17-25
20th	“Imagine It All”	Colossians 1:11-17
23rd	Thanksgiving Eve Service at Lake Nokomis Lutheran, 7pm	
27th	“Seeing the Word: Swords into Plowshares” <i>Guest preacher: Hope Hutchison</i>	Isaiah 2:1-5

Future Events at Minnehaha UMC—Save the Date

- Dec. 9 – Taizé Service at 7:00 with a Blue Christmas theme
- Dec. 17 – MinneHarvest – one week earlier than the usual date due to Christmas
- Dec. 18 -- 4:00 Christmas Pageant and dinner
- Dec. 24 -- 4:00 and 10:00 Christmas Eve Services
- Dec. 25 -- Yes, Christmas falls on a Sunday this year! One service at 10:00
- Jan. 1 – One service at 10:00
- Jan. 8 – United Methodist Women Sunday
- Jan. 11 – Food Shelf fundraising pasta dinner
- Jan. 13 – 7:00 Taizé
- Jan. 22 – Infant Recognition during both worship services
- Jan. 22 – 1:00 Annual Meeting to pass the budget and elect new leaders
- Jan. 27-29 Winter Retreat at Camp Koronis
- Jan. 28 – MinneHarvest
- Feb. 10 – 7:00 Taizé
- Feb. 24-26 – Annual Winter Play
- Feb. 25 -- MinneHarvest
- Feb. 25 – My Changing Self workshop for children, youth, and parents
- Feb. 26 – Camping Sunday



Join with others in the Minnehaha community for this year's **Winter Retreat** from January 27th to January 29th at Koronis Assembly Grounds in Paynesville. People of all ages will gather for fellowship, reflection, time in nature, time indoors, music, games, learning, and more.

This year, we will explore what it takes for individuals and groups to move from isolation to community. Looking at the Biblical depiction of immigration – what it means to be an

immigrant and what it means to welcome people into community – and reflecting on our own experiences of being in both isolation and in community, we'll consider what we can do as a community to truly open our hearts and doors.

We hope you will consider being a part of this wonderful weekend. More information and registration materials will be available beginning November 12th.

November Youth Events at Minnehaha UMC

Nov. 6 Confirmation: Reading the Bible as a spiritual practice. Classes are from 6:00-7:30pm. Grades 6th-7th are with Lani in the 3rd floor Youth Room, 8th-9th Graders are with Becky in the Wesley Room, and 10th-12th Graders are with Kate in room 306.

Nov. 13 Youth night: Nerf Night in the basement! For grades 6th-12th from 6-8pm there will be soft bullets flying everywhere as we participate in many different team building games. There is no cost for this event.

Nov. 18 Overnight Lock-in: At MUMC for 8th-12th graders. Please RSVP. Starts at 6:00pm and goes until 8am the next morning. Contact Lani Thompson for more details!

Nov. 20 Confirmation: Maps & Geography. Classes are from 6:00-7:30pm. Grades 6th-7th are with Lani in the 3rd floor Youth Room, 8th-9th Graders are with Becky in the Wesley Room, and 10th-12th Graders are with Kate in room 306.

Nov. 27 Confirmation: Bible: Acts and Letters. Classes are from 6:00-7:30pm. Grades 6th-7th are with Lani in the 3rd floor Youth Room, 8th-9th Graders are with Becky in the Wesley Room, and 10th-12th Graders are with Kate in room 306.

Dec. 4 Confirmation: Bible: Revelation. Classes are from 6:00-7:30pm. Grades 6th-7th are with Lani in the 3rd floor Youth Room, 8th-9th Graders are with Becky in the Wesley Room, and 10th-12th Graders are with Kate in room 306.



2016 Confilmands Kiriana Marie Cole, Tait Anders Erickson, Ella Rose Hougén, Sydney Elin Miller

Taizé

For some of you, the Sunday morning worship does not provide enough time for quiet, reflection, prayer and silence. We invite you to feed your soul with our monthly Taizé Service. The service is modeled after the worship services at the ecumenical community of Taizé, located in eastern France. The service has prayer, scripture, and music. The songs have few words, sung repetitively, in order to allow for deep contemplation and prayer. Join us on Friday, November 11, at 7:00 or any second Friday of the month.

Monthly Communion at Nokomis Square

On the second Thursday of the month at 1:00 p.m., Becky offers a brief communion service at Nokomis Square preceded by a conversation/study on some topic of interest. Anyone is welcome to come. This month we will be gathering on November 10.

Charge Conference

Charge Conference is the official word we use for an all-church meeting that takes places during Church Council. The reason for our charge conference on Nov. 15 will be the setting of salary for Becky Sechrist. We do this before the formal budget is adopted because the denomination requires that all salaries be set by December 1 so that the numbers can be processed by the pensions people. If our budgeting process prompts a change in salary, then we can make a correction and vote on it the same time we vote on the budget, sending in amended paperwork at that time. Everyone is always welcome to attend a Church Council meeting, and anyone who is a member can vote at the charge conference.

O K Gang

The OLDER KIDS, a group of Seniors better known as the O. K. Gang, have retired! Our finale was Wednesday, October 19, 2016.

Our custom—our minister, Rev. Becky, sent us off with a prayer. 22 of us were blest with a gorgeous day of fall colors, delicious dinner at Rudy's restaurant in White Bear Lake, then on to Pine Tree Apple Orchard where most walked back to the coach with bags of apples and bakery goodies.

Children's Ministries

What a beautiful fall it's been! We've very much enjoyed the vibrant colors of the leaves on the trees, and are now finding equal enjoyment in jumping in them on the ground. Our neighborhood is filled with Halloween decorations, and costumes are set and ready to go. But, in the midst of this autumnal glee, thoughts of winter are beginning to creep in. In fact, we're knee-deep in Advent planning here at Minnehaha, and my next task at hand is to order some Wise People crowns for the Pageant. It's exciting to think about, but I want to pause for a moment to reflect on the last two months.

We've had a great start to the program year - with a great group of volunteers teaching Sunday School, and the kids doing a wonderful job settling into new classrooms and routines, and connecting with each other and their teachers. The energy has been high, the children inquisitive and kind. We had a great first "Choose Your Own Adventure" - with kids choosing a Halloween Craft, Crocheting, or Game Time. Thank you to those who've helped out in any aspect of Sunday School, and to all you parents for sharing your amazing kids with us!

We hope to keep this momentum going into the next season - and it will certainly be a busy one! As we move into November, we've got a lot to keep track off - and we hope you mark your calendars and join us for as much as you are able:

NOVEMBER:

Thursdays: Minnehaha Playgroup - from 9-11am in the Child Care Room. Join the "Minnehaha Playgroup" group on Facebook or contact Tanya Ketcham for more information.

Throughout November: Food Drive for the Food Shelf - culminating in the Thanksgiving Processional on the 20th of November.

Sunday Mornings: During the Sunday School hour (10:15-11:00), we'll start introducing Christmas Pageant songs and doing general preparations

Sunday, 6th November: Children's Choir (First through Fifth Graders) singing in both worship services

Saturday, 12th November: Holiday Bazaar! Be sure to stop by the Children's Boutique for your child(ren) to do their Christmas Shopping without you!

Saturday, 19th November: Consider coming to help distribute food at MinneHarvest

Sunday, 20th November: Cherub Choir (Preschool and Kindergartners) singing in both worship services; ALL CHILDREN invited to participate in our Thanksgiving Procession at the beginning of both worship services.

Sunday, 27th November: First Sunday of Advent - Advent Wreath Making Party at 10am (in lieu of Sunday School) in the Fellowship Hall

Looking ahead to December, this year's **Christmas Pageant will be on Sunday, 18th December at 4pm.** The Final Rehearsal will be on Wednesday, 14th December.

Please let me know if you have any questions or concerns about any of this!

We look forward to a wonderful holiday season together,

Jenia Strom

Director of Children and Family Ministries



Minnehaha Playgroup

For Children 5 and Under & their Caregivers

Thursdays, from 9-11am

Stop in to play, talk, explore, support, and learn together. Feel free to bring snacks (no peanuts, please) if your child will need them. No RSVP necessary. All are welcome.

hosted by

Minnehaha United Methodist Church

When weather permits, we gather at local parks for playgroup. Otherwise, we meet at Minnehaha UMC, in the Childcare Room. If you'd like to join us on any given week, and want to know where to find us: join the "Minnehaha Playgroup" Facebook Page for weekly updates.



Highlights from the October 11, 2016 Church Council Meeting

TREASURER'S REPORT: Our finances are on track. The General Fund is expected to end the year with revenues equaling expenses. We're in a solid cash position. And the church remains current on its obligations to staff, vendors, contractors, apportionments and the inter-fund loan through September 30, 2016. (Dennis Feller, Treasurer)

WANT TO PROMOTE A CHURCH EVENT? If you have a church event to promote, use the Event Media Form on the church website (www.minnehaha.org). Fill out the form and then give it to Sybylla Yeoman Hendrix, the Communications Chairperson. She'll take it from there and get the information into newspapers, social media, bulletins, websites and more. (Sybylla Yeoman Hendrix, Communications Chair)

QUESTION: SHOULD THE CHURCH OFFER FREE WIFI TO EVERYONE? The Church Council was asked the question: Should the church make free WiFi available for everyone throughout the church? Many churches do. There is a cost, so it would have to be part of the budget. The construction of the building doesn't make it easy. Privacy and security are also issues. Still, it can be done. But should we? Talk to your Church Council members and let them know your thoughts. (Dean Ammerman, Council Chair)

CEMENT AND COFFEE: Your Trustees have been extremely busy. The area in which the oil tank was removed settled so that we were able to pour a new cement pad there. Also, a small cement "bench pad" was poured on the southwest corner of the church building, and a memorial bench was installed. Also, the commercial coffee maker in the kitchen broke and a new coffee machine was purchased to replace it. (Kim Kanuit, Trustees; Gene Thompson, Building & Grounds)

YOUTH PROGRAM DOING GREAT THINGS: Our youth are meeting Sunday evenings from 6:00 to 7:30 p.m. They're involved in the worship services as Acolytes. They have ambitious plans how to Seek, Serve and Celebrate this year. (Check the wall in the Upper Room on the Third Floor.) The first Youth Night outing took 13 youth and 3 adults to the Mall of America Ropes course. Going forward, sixth through eighth graders will attend "The Event" retreat, which is put on by the Minnesota Annual Conference of the United Methodist Church. The youth are providing babysitting during the Harvest Homecoming Dinner & Concert. They're traveling to Rochester to work with the Rochester Saturday meal program to help feed the hungry. They're running games and the haunted house at the annual church Halloween Party. And they're doing Nerf Night team building games in November. (Lani Thompson, Coordinator of Youth Ministries)

SUPPORT THE MINNEHAHA FOOD SHELF: You can support the Food Shelf in a lot of different ways. Place a donation in the offering plate using the envelope in the pews. Plan to come to the annual Pasta Dinner on January 11 (the Accordion Band will be there!). On two Sundays in November the Food Shelf will present a short list of items they need, so you can pick something up when you're out shopping. Thanks for helping your neighbors in need. (Judy Durfey, Food Shelf Chair)

APPROVING PASTOR'S 2017 SALARY: At the next meeting of the Church Council on November 15 at 6:30 p.m., we will convene a Charge Conference to approve Becky's salary for 2017. All are invited to attend and participate in the discussion. (Dean Ammerman, Council Chair)

NEXT MEETING NOVEMBER 15 AT 6:30 PM: The next Church Council meeting is scheduled for November 15 at 6:30 p.m. Everyone in the church is invited to attend. Complete minutes of the meeting are available on request.

—submitted by Dean Ammerman, Church Council Chair

Elections

Just a reminder that Tuesday, November 8 is election day. Not only is this an encouragement to vote, but it is a reminder that Minnehaha UMC is a polling place. You may have noticed that since it is a Tuesday, it is also a Food Shelf day. If you use Minnehaha as your polling place, just be aware that both events are happening at the same day; your patience and attitude of hospitality would be greatly appreciated.

Stewards

We are all stewards, right from the beginning of creation. God entrusts creation to us, telling us to tend to it so that it might multiply and flourish. The same is true for our church. We are stewards of our building, our people, and our ministries. God has entrusted us to each other, calling on us to tend to the congregation so that it might multiply and flourish. We are stewards of our time, our energy, and our finances. And it is true that the church needs all of those things. Our membership vows ask us to pledge our prayers, our presence, our gifts, our service, and our witness. We won't multiply and flourish without all those things from each of you, so please pray regularly for the people of Minnehaha, and for the community as a whole. Be present wherever you can to whoever you can – in worship, but also at educational events, service opportunities, and at fellowship events. We are always better with your presence! Tell others about the great things we are doing here, and about how life at Minnehaha feeds your soul. And, give what you can. Sometimes people make the gift of items the church needs, but we also need money so we can do things like pay the heating bill and the light bill, not to mention the staff. Some of those things might seem dull, but our building and our staff are frequently the keys to the wonderful ministry that we are able to do. Look for the letter you should have received in the mail, consider increasing your pledge by 10% over what you gave last year, and then turn your pledge cards in by Sunday, Nov. 20. If you didn't get a letter (or can't find one), we will have spare ones available outside the sanctuary each Sunday, or you can call or email the office to have one sent to you. And if you didn't make a pledge last year to our 3-year capital campaign, consider doing so this year, because the mortgage payment is important too. Thank you in advance for being a good steward of this congregation.

Thank you MUMC family for the prayers, calls, visits, the prayer shawl and visits from Becky during my recent hospitalization. I'm home and on the mend and feeling improvement every day.

Thank you for all the love being sent.

Jim Shetler

All Saints Sunday

We will be celebrating All Saints Sunday on November 6 at both worship services. During the service, we will read the names of all the members of the congregation who have died since the last All Saints Sunday, remembering their lives and their ministry among us. If you know of any family members or good friends of people who have died in the last year, please be sure to extend an invitation to them to join us.

★ United Methodist Women

We want everyone to at least come if not help out at the Nov. 12 Bazaar! Opportunities to sign up are listed in the narthex between services every Sunday.

- ★ The Sit Down Players will be performing again this December! I am looking for people who can sit down, can read and are available to rehearse on Wed. afternoons in late November and early December. Please let me know if you would like to be included in this group! Maureen Trepp at 612-724-7620.
- ★ There is a Cookie Exchange date of Dec. 3. Bring 10 dozen cookies or your dough or your ingredients and bake the cookies right in our kitchen ovens. We will start at 9:00 and "exchange" the cookies at noon.
- ★ We will be serving dinner at Simpson Shelter on Friday, Dec. 16; preparing it the night before. Please save that date and join us!



United
Methodist
Women

ACORN 2020

St. James on the Parkway Episcopal Church has begun a conversation and visioning process for the future called ACORN 2020. St. James has reached out to us and to Lake Nokomis Lutheran to be part of that conversation. The three congregations have a decades-old history of working together on things from the worship at Minnehaha Falls to the Food Shelf. ACORN 2020 is looking at the greater community and is investigating the opportunities surrounding the strengthening and growing the partnership among our three congregations. This could mean worship, learning, and community service. The first step will be to identify both synergies and unique aspects of each congregation and from there look at greater opportunities for collaboration. The conversation might cover sharing aspects of facilities, resources, and community outreach. The dialog will cover big picture topics and more information will be shared as we develop concepts for consideration. Janice Linster has agreed to be a representative from Minnehaha UMC to ACORN 2020, and she will be bringing periodic reports back to the Church Council. If you are interested in learning more, feel free to talk to her. And, if you are interested in being part of this conversation as well, please let Becky Sechrist know; we could use a couple more people from Minnehaha UMC to be part of this ongoing work.

Volunteers Needed

"A Redbird Christmas" Annual Holiday Bazaar

By the Minnehaha United Methodist Women

Saturday, November 12 from 9am – 2pm

Our annual Holiday Bazaar is only a couple days away! Make sure to mark your calendars **NOW** to save the date. It's a great way to jump start your Christmas shopping. Spread the word to your friends, family, coworkers, and neighbors!

This is our main mission fundraiser of the year and as always, many hands make for light work. We are always looking for help in these areas: **Greeting, Cashiering, Children's Boutique, the Kitchen, Waitressing, Dishwashing, the Dessert Table, General Set-up, Granny's Corner, UMW Store and Cleanup.** Men can help too.

Look for a list of options posted on the UMW bulletin board on the lower level or contact Kim Kanuit, Maureen Trepp, or Jenia Strom so they can to add you on! Phone numbers are listed below.

We also accept these types of donations:

Bake Sale: Homemade baked goods – cookies, cupcakes, and bars

Dessert Table: Homemade desserts – cakes and pies (especially pumpkin)

UMW Crafter's table: Homemade crafts – knitted, stitched, crocheted, painted, etc...

Granny's Corner: Antiques and collectibles. Consignment items are also accepted.

Children's Boutique: New items that a Mom and Dad might enjoy receiving from a young child.

Bring **non-perishable** items to the stage area Sunday, November 6 through Thursday, November 10.

Bring **perishable** items on Friday or Saturday morning, November 11 or 12.

Contact Kim Kanuit - 612-860-0256, Maureen Trepp - 612-724-7620, or Jenia Strom - 612-722-2754 to volunteer or with questions.

WHERE DOES OUR MISSION MONEY GO?

Your generosity will be shared with these following missions:

National Division of the United Methodist Women: Global Mission Projects including UMCOR (United Methodist

Council on Relief), **Feed My Starving Children:** Feeding children in over 55 countries around the world, **Haiti Solar**

Oven Project: Providing solar ovens for cooking and water pasteurization, **Emma Norton Services:** Serving women and

children in need of supportive housing, **Joyce Pre-School:** Quality preschool education for children of diverse back-

grounds, **Simpson Shelter:** Serving families experiencing homelessness, **Walker Care Fund:** Providing funds for the spe-

cial needs of Walker residents, **Meals via Wheels:** Providing home-delivered meals to people in our community.

Your generosity will also help support these Minnehaha programs:

Food Shelf: Food distribution to local residents, **Minneharvest:** Food distribution with no resident restrictions, **Youth:**

Mission programs and educational scholarships, **Hospitality:** Kitchen expenses and supportive communit, **Pastor's Dis-**

cretionary Fund: Support for those with special needs, **UMW:** Speakers, Literature/Reading program, and School of Christian Mission.

THANK YOU!

Toy Drive

During the Tuesdays of December Food Self Parents are able to select toys for their children ranging from baby toys to dolls to hot wheels to table foosball to MP3 players and clock radios for older children.

Each child received a toy , a stocking stuffer and a hat and or gloves if needed. We also had gift bags and wrapping paper. All this is made possible by the generosity of members of Minnehaha.

There are three ways to help with this mission one of the ways we serve.

Buy toys and bring them to church

Designate an offering for toys in the Sunday offering

Donate cash to be used for toys

With your help Good things will happen here



Thanksgiving Eve Worship

Lake Nokomis Lutheran Church is hosting our communal Thanksgiving Eve service this year, so plan on showing up at 5011 31st Ave. S at 7:00 on Wednesday, November 23. Also joining us will be the congregations of Living Table United Church of Christ, St. James Episcopal on the Parkway, and Bethel Evangelical Lutheran Church. There will be a mass choir (which anyone is welcome to join) with a joint rehearsal prior to the worship service. Look in the bulletins prior to Thanksgiving for the precise time. We'll have some time to meet each other and renew ongoing relationships afterwards, so if you can help out by bringing a pie to share with others, that would be great. Pies can be home-made or store-bought, and as simple or as complicated as you want. We look forward to seeing you the night before Thanksgiving as we come to God with gratitude for all that God has given us.

Time Change

It's time to fall back and gain that hour we lost in the spring. Set your clocks back one hour before coming to worship on Sunday, Nov. 6. If you forget, we'll have some coffee on for you as you wait for everyone else to arrive.

Hurricane Matthew

The United Methodist Committee on Relief (UMCOR) is responding in a variety of ways to the destruction and death caused by Hurricane Matthew. There are several ways you can help too.

UMCOR is currently responding to Hurricane Matthew by providing emergency supplies, through a water purification program in partnership with GlobalMedic, and via a food-distribution program through the Haitian church. Initial assistance from UMCOR will exceed \$150,000.

Here are four ways you can help the people and areas impacted by Hurricane Matthew:

1. Pray for all of those impacted by the hurricane—those who have lost loved ones and homes, those who have had to flee their communities, and first responders and others who are providing assistance where it's needed most.
2. Make a donation to [UMCOR International Disaster Response, Advance # 982450](#), or [UMCOR U.S. Disaster Response, Advance #901670](#). UMCOR is already on the ground, working alongside first responders to provide emergency food, water, and health supplies. You can make your contribution directly to UMCOR through their website, or you can write out a check to Minnehaha and indicate "Haiti" on the memo line and we'll make sure it gets there.
3. Make a donation to [Feed My Starving Children](#)—and/or go pack meals at one of its sites. Food is urgently needed in the Caribbean. The Minnesota Conference partners with this organization in sending food to many countries in the world, and special containers of food are currently being sent to southwest Haiti.
4. Make and send [UMCOR health kits](#), which provide basic necessities to people who have been forced to leave their homes because of human conflict or natural disaster. The need is great, not only in Haiti but in the Bahamas and the southeast United States.

Inkjet Cartridge Recycling

The Raptor Center has given up the recycling of inkjet cartridges, which they have done since 2003, to the Wildlife Rehabilitation Center of Minnesota. They have recycled over 100,000 cartridges since its start.

The Wildlife Rehab Center (WRC) focuses on all animals, birds, turtles, all kinds of little critters. I encourage your participation in this continuing care of the other creatures of our earth.



December Newsletter Deadline

Newsletter items for December are due on Wednesday, November 16th. This is a change from the usual Friday deadline. Due to the holiday late items are not able to be accepted. Thank you.

Annual Holiday Bazaar

by the Minnehaha United Methodist Women

A Redbird Christmas

Saturday, November 12, 2016

9:00 a.m. – 2:00 p.m.

**Gifts, Crafts, Fine
Art, Antiques,
Collectibles, Food
and more!**

BREAKFAST

9:00 – 11:00 a.m.

Egg Bake, Cinnamon Rolls

LUNCH

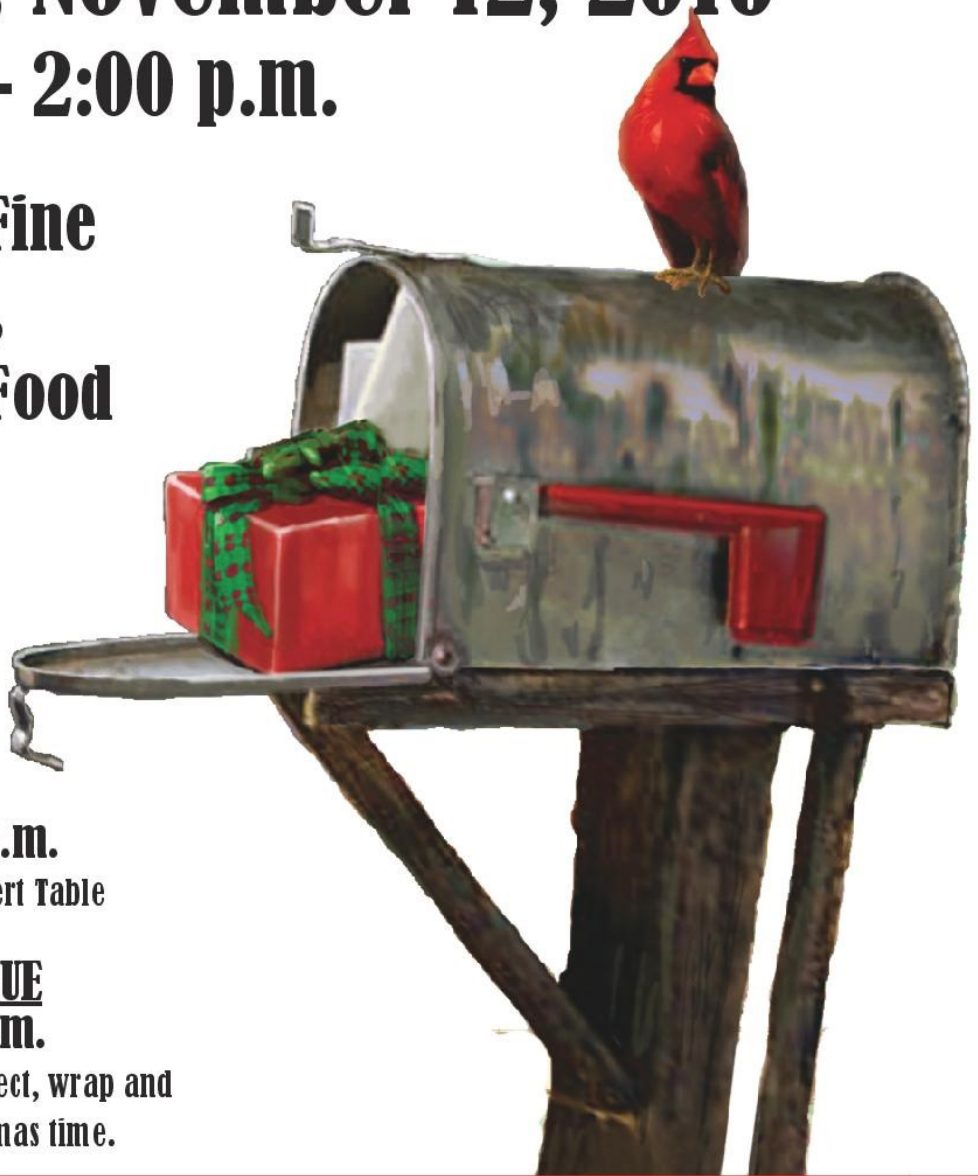
11:00 a.m. – 1:00 p.m.

Hot Dish, Sloppy Joes, Dessert Table

CHILDREN'S BOUTIQUE

9:00 a.m. – 1:00 p.m.

Fun gifts for children to select, wrap and
give their parents at Christmas time.



Minnehaha United Methodist Church

3701 East 50th Street • Minneapolis, MN 55417

(612) 721-6231 • www.minnehaha.org

Note from the pastor



Imagine . . .

Our imaginations can be rich, helping us to explore places, people, relationships, topics that sit at the edge of our awareness. I was recently in a conversation with our bishop where I got to share with him a “waking dream” I have had of the church, and I told him that this daydream of what the church might be some day is one of the things that allows me to do ministry in the here and not yet. I don’t think I’m unique in this. Lots of us settle for an imperfect now in hopes of what could be down the road. We can sense the potential beneath the surface, and we work hard to bring it to fruition, only to imagine something even better! That’s what’s great about being part of a faith community. Not only am I imagining better things, but so are each and every one of you. Together, our corporate imaginations are bigger than any one of our imaginations. And, God’s imagination is even bigger than anything we can conceive, so really there is no limit to what is possible if we are willing to align our imaginings with God’s and then follow them.

Some of you imagine a sanctuary filled with people. Some of you imagine expanding our outreach into the community so that we are able to not just feed people, but also tutor children, or lobby for changes in social policy. Some of you imagine Sunday School rooms filled with children and youth, and others of you imagine a regular childcare program so that you can enjoy the company of other adults at church while knowing your children are in good hands for an hour or two. Some of you imagine a multitude of programming aimed at very specific groups of adults, and others of you imagine the richness of multi-generational programming so that we all benefit from both the wisdom of age and the energy of youth. Many of you have dreams that we have barely touched on, and many more imagine things that haven’t even been expressed out loud yet. And to all of it, I say “Amen!” Our future will rely on what we imagine today, and how we are willing to pay attention to God’s imagination for us. So, let your mind wander. Consider all the things we might do and be. Pray for insight into where God might be leading us, be part of this community that imagines, and moves, into our future together.

In joy,

Becky



*Alice Streed's great-granddaughter
Everett was baptized Oct. 23*



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11/16



For I was hungry, and you gave me food...



Celebrate Thanksgiving with the Minnehaha UMC Community
by bringing food for our food shelf.

Donations are always accepted, but in recognition of Thanksgiving, we
encourage you to bring them with you to worship
on November 6th, 13th, and 20th.

Currently, the Food Shelf is in need of: hearty soups, canned fruit, one dish
meals, and personal care items. Monetary Donations are also always
welcome. Thank you for your generosity!

It's time for Advent.
Time to: Prepare. Focus. Hope. Love. Joy. Wonder. Breath.
It's time to prepare our hearts.
It's time to share the story & to share the light.



Join us as we begin the Advent season with an

Advent Wreath Making Party
EVERYONE is INVITED

Minnehaha United Methodist Church
Sunday, November 27th
10am in the Fellowship Hall
Cost for each wreath: \$8